

THE RAPAPORT FAMILY ARCHIVE

Film pack - text and pictures in one file

For Dov Bernard Rapaport, eighty on 28 August 2026.

Upload THIS FILE to whatever tool makes the film. It is a PDF on purpose: notebook tools import text and images from PDFs, but they do NOT import images from Markdown or from a website, so a film built from the text alone would tell this family's story with none of this family's faces in it.

This file is English only. Embedding Hebrew properly needs a right-to-left layout engine, and a half-rendered Hebrew caption in a memorial film is worse than none. The Hebrew, Polish and French versions live on the site and in the Markdown pack at <https://rapaportfamily.github.io/llm/>

THE SIX RULES

1. Never invent. Every claim must trace to a record in this file.
2. Show conflicts as conflicts. This archive publishes disagreements rather than tidying them away.
3. Lusia's memoir is testimony, not proof. Where documents confirm it, say so. Where nothing corroborates it, say so - and say why: the people who would have kept the records are the people who were killed.
4. Living people: no birth dates.
5. Never put a name on any picture captioned UNIDENTIFIED.
6. Illustration is allowed but must be visibly marked as illustration.
7. A document is not a face. Every portrait was checked by eye on 19 August 2026 and 40 of the 74 pictures the trees carried as portraits turned out to be passports, certificates, Yad Vashem pages, a gravestone, a missing-persons card. This file prints verified faces only.

THE STORY

0. Before the beginning - Radomysl Wielki (1850 - 1886)

For a year this family could go back no further than a name on a passport. The paternal line stopped at Berisz Rapaport, and even Edward Gelles, who spent twenty-five years on the Rapaport rabbinical genealogies, could not carry it past him. In May 2026 Basia found the passport file itself, and inside it were his parents: Moses Saul Rapaport and Menukha.

Berisz was born on 30 July 1886 in Radomysl Wielki, and the family's registered commune was Dabrowa Tarnowska - a town nobody could account for until July 2026, when Basia read the Tarnow notarial records and found Szabse Rapaport serving as rabbi of Dabrowa until 20 April 1884. That is why the passport says Dabrowa. The same evening, from a completely different direction, Dana was sent a record naming Schabse with Figa/Yete.

Three marriage deeds from Tarnow - 1919, 1920 and 1923, for three of Berisz's sisters - each independently name the same couple as their parents. Three separate clerks, in three different years, writing the same two names. That is as close to certainty as this kind of research reaches.

Behind all of it now stands a spine of paper. Fifty-eight civil-register photographs came from Basia's archive on 6 August 2026 - twenty-seven births, eleven marriages, nineteen deaths - running from a birth in 1818 to a death in 1934. They are the ordinary machinery of a town: a clerk writing down that a child was born, that two people married, that someone died. Read together they carry six generations of this family from Abraham Abe, born 1784, down to the parents of the man this archive is written for. The naming was tested before any of it was believed: twenty-seven of the twenty-eight birth records carry the same year this archive already held for that person. One does not - a birth filed 1849 where we hold 1850 - and it is published as the disagreement it is.

1. Nadworna - David (1911)

David Mendel Rapaport - Memek - was born in Nadworna on 25 December 1911, son of Berisz Rapaport and Rebeka Griffel. Nadworna sat in the Carpathian foothills of eastern Galicia, then Austria-Hungary, then Poland, today Nadvirna in Ukraine.

His Brussels Displaced Persons card of 1946 gives his birthplace as "Cieszyn (Tessin)" - a town four hundred kilometres away, where no one in this family ever lived. It is a transcription error by a French clerk, and it is worth pausing on: here the document is wrong and the family's memory is right. That is why nothing in this archive ranks paper above testimony as a rule.

2. Bolechow - Lusia (1913 - 1933)

Leah Weitzner - Lusia - was born in Bolechow on 8 April, daughter of Elias (Eliyahu) Weitzner and Matel (Matylda) nee Weinreb. Every record agrees on the day. They do not agree on the year: the Bolechow civil register says 1913, while her own survivor card, the ZIH index and the Haifa burial register all say 1916. Three against two, but the two include the civil register. It remains unresolved.

In 1933 her parents left for Mandatory Palestine. Lusia stayed. It is a small sentence with the whole of what follows inside it: she would not see them again for fifteen years, and the war would fall on the side of the family that remained.

3. The marriage, and Shimon (1935 - 1938)

They married on 10 February 1935 in Bolechow, her own town. She was twenty-one and he was twenty-three.

Her memoir puts the wedding in Muszyna, in February 1938 - three years later and in another town. Written forty years afterwards, the memory placed the marriage at the opening of the Muszyna years rather than three years before them. The month is right in both. And the record resolves something the memoir left broken: under her date, Shimon arrives eight months before his parents marry; under the register, he is born two and a half years into the marriage.

Shimon was born on 22 June 1937 in Lwow. The family had long said "Mosina" - a name that turned out to be Muszyna - but his own survivor card, filled in after the war, says Lwow.

4. The war (1939 - 1944)

Germany invaded Poland on 1 September 1939. What the family did over the next five years is known almost entirely from Lusia's testimony, because almost no one who could have written it down survived to do so.

She tells of Przemyśl under Soviet administration; of the Nadworna ghetto and David's escape from it hidden in a wooden wagon; of false identities in Lwów; of the Hormak family, and of neighbours named Pietrzycki and Ivanov who helped them; and of Shimon, three years old, kept in a crate for two and a half years so that he would not be seen or heard. No document we hold corroborates any of it. That is not a weakness in the account - it is what happens when the people who would have kept the records are the people who were killed.

Two things from those years are on paper. David was stripped of Polish citizenship in 1942. And his father Berisz was murdered at Auschwitz - not on an approximate date but on a known one. He was given prisoner number 27310, arrived at the camp on 27 March 1942 and was dead on 29 March. Two days. Two independent records say so and agree exactly: the Auschwitz-Birkenau State Museum's victim page, and the camp's own Sterbebücher, the death books kept for registered prisoners. The register adds one word that matters - his residence, Przemyśl. Lusia's memoir, written from memory decades later, says David's parents were in Przemyśl when the war came and that the Germans killed one of them there. A German clerk writing at the time put him in the same town. Neither could have copied the other. The camp recorded his occupation as robotnik, labourer; he was an industrialist in Stanisławów, and that word is the camp's, not his. And we now know where he was taken from. His transport, number 689, was fifty-five men from the PRISON IN TARNÓW, registered together on 27 March 1942 with numbers 27305 to 27359 and sent by the Security Police of the Kraków district; Berisz was the sixth number in that block. Eighteen of the fifty-five were recorded as Jewish and seventeen of them died; at least forty-one of the fifty-five did. So he was not seized in Przemyśl and sent east - he was held in Tarnów, a short way from Radomysł Wielki where he was born, in the town whose address the family still carried in 1924: Folwarczna 9.

And they were remembered. For a long time this page said that no Page of Testimony had ever been filed at Yad Vashem for Berisz or for Rebeka, and that this archive was their only written memorial anywhere. That was wrong - and not because the evidence was missing. Both pages were already here, attached to their own records in this archive's document list: No. 53072 for Bernard, No. 53074 for Regina, each signed on 26 April 1953. The story simply had not been read against the file it was built on. Basia's copies, which arrived on 6 August 2026, are what finally prompted the check. Berisz's page names his father Moshe and his mother Menucha, gives his trade as merchant and sets his death in 1940 - eleven years after the fact, and two years early. Rebeka's gives her birth as 1892 in Nadworna and her death as 1943; this archive holds 1888 and 1942. Those dates disagree and are left disagreeing. What does not disagree is that in the spring of 1953 somebody who had known them sat down and wrote their names on a form so they would not be lost. They were never unremembered. We had simply not looked at what we were holding. And now we know whose hand. The declaration at the foot of both pages is a filer living in Haifa, signing on 26 April 1953, and where the form asks what he was to the person it says on his father's page and on his mother's - his son, her son. Berish and Rebeka had one son. David wrote them. Seven years after he came ashore he sat down and filled in two forms for his parents, and put his father's death two years wrong, because he was writing from memory about people he had last seen before the war.

5. Katowice - and a separation nobody recorded (1945 - 1946)

The war ended and they came west with the repatriation, to Katowice. On 1 July 1946 Lusia and Shimon each filed a survivor-registration card at the Katowice committee - cards 151738 and 151337, mother and son, one after the other.

But David had been registered as a Displaced Person in Brussels since 9 April 1946 - three months earlier. On the day he was recorded in Belgium, his wife and son were still in Poland. He had gone ahead, and they followed later that year. The memoir says only that "the family reaches Brussels and stays in a hotel": one movement, everyone together. The two cards, held in this archive since May and never read against each other until August 2026, say otherwise. It is the first of the two separations in this story.

6. Brussels - and Dov (1946)

And she was there first. For as long as this archive has existed, the earliest Brussels record in it was

David's Displaced Persons card of 9 April 1946. On 19 August 2026 Basia sent Lusia's: she registered in the same city on 26 DECEMBER 1945, three and a half months earlier, signing it "Rapaport Lea" while the clerk filed her under her maiden name. Two days later a Jewish aid society asked the Belgians to let her stay six months; on 7 February 1946 the Ministry of Justice agreed, on condition the permission was marked "with a view to emigration" - she could be in Belgium only while waiting to leave it. She was living at 250 rue des Coteaux in Schaerbeek. Dov was born under that arrangement. Her card carries two things nobody can yet explain: it says she came from a camp in Prague, which appears nowhere else and not in her own book; and it gives her birthplace as Haifa, Palestine. She was born in Bolechow. David's card of the same series names Cieszyn, also wrong. Two cards, two wrong birthplaces - and on hers, under destination, the word Palestine.

David's Displaced Persons card describes a forestry engineer, Polish nationality stripped in 1942, speaking Polish, Italian, German, Czech and Russian. It is the only document that reaches across from the war into what came after.

Dov Bernard Rapaport was born in Brussels on 28 August 1946. No Belgian birth registration is held in this archive - it is the easiest missing document of all, and only he can request it, as the person the record belongs to.

One thing about Belgium had been sitting in plain sight. David's aunt Jente - his father's sister - spent the war in Liege, at Rue Lairesse 88, registered as a Polish national. Her daughter Szewa married there in 1941, a marriage this archive already held without seeing what stood behind it. So when David and Lusia reached Belgium in 1946, it was not a country the family had never been to: part of it had lived there straight through the occupation, a hundred kilometres from Brussels. Whether David went where he had people, no document in our hands says. It is worth asking and it is not worth inventing.

7. Sete, the Theodor Herzl, Cyprus (1947 - 1948)

On 2 April 1947 David and Shimon sailed from Sete in southern France aboard the Theodor Herzl - the ex-British cable-layer HMS Guardian, built at Newcastle in 1907, carrying 2,641 ma'apilim gathered from camps across France and Belgium. Shimon was nine. Lusia stayed behind in Brussels with the seven-month-old Dov.

On 13 April the Royal Navy boarded her off the coast. The passengers fought; three were killed and twenty-seven wounded. Everyone aboard was deported to Cyprus, and David and Shimon were interned at Karaolos, north of Famagusta, for about eight months. The camps there held 53,510 Jews behind wire between 1946 and 1949, and some two thousand children were born inside them. Shimon was released from Atlit in 1948.

8. Haifa (1948 - 1996)

Lusia sailed from Brussels with Dov on the Kadima. She had waited more than a year alone with the baby, working, while David and Shimon were behind wire. The Haifa burial register records her year of immigration as 1948 and David's as 1946 - the two-year gap the memoir describes, written into their own graves. Dov's first journey was with his mother, the two of them.

In Haifa she saw her parents for the first time since 1933. The family settled on Abbas Street, and later bought an apartment on Moriah Street with German reparations - money David argued with himself about taking. He worked as a customs broker, the trade his son Dov followed, and then his grandson Doron.

In 1986 a granddaughter, Hadas, asked her teacher Esther Weiss for help with a school assignment, and Esther sat down and interviewed Lusia. Ninety pages in Hebrew. Without them, almost nothing in this archive between 1939 and 1948 would have a voice at all.

David died on 29 August 1990 and Lusia on 28 December 1996. They are buried beside one another at Sde Yehoshua, graves 102 and 102. Her burial record names her father Eliyahu and her mother Matilda - the same two people her memoir opens with, sixty years earlier and in another language. The last page of the record matches the first page of the testimony.

9. Going back (2015 - 2019)

In April 2015 Dov flew to Poland with his son Doron. They spent a week in Warsaw - the Old Town, the Barbican, the Royal Castle, a city flattened and put back stone by stone - and on 19 April they drove

to Przemyśl. That is not a sightseeing stop. Przemyśl is the town where Berish and Rebeka were living when the war came; it is the residence the Auschwitz death books give for Berish, and it is where Lusía's memoir says the Germans killed one of David's parents on a fabricated charge. Most of the forty photographs from that day are taken through a car windscreen, driving its streets slowly, in the rain.

In June 2018 he went to Brussels, where he was born on 28 August 1946 - four months after his father filled in a Displaced Persons card in that city and wrote "Palestine or U.S.A." in the box for where he wanted to go. In January 2019 he went to Katowice, in the snow, and photographed it from above and on foot: the town of the separation nobody recorded, where the family was together before David and Shimon went one way and Lusía and the baby another. One hundred and twenty photographs from the four journeys are in this archive.

It is worth saying what that means for an archive like this one. Every other chapter here is assembled from what other people wrote down - clerks, registrars, a camp administration, a memoir. This is the only chapter in which somebody in the story goes back and looks for himself, and the pictures are his. Nothing in them was recovered. They were made.

THE PICTURES

Every image below is a real photograph or a real document held by this family. Captions say what each one is. Use them.

Portraits



Dov Rapaport (1946-08-28 -)

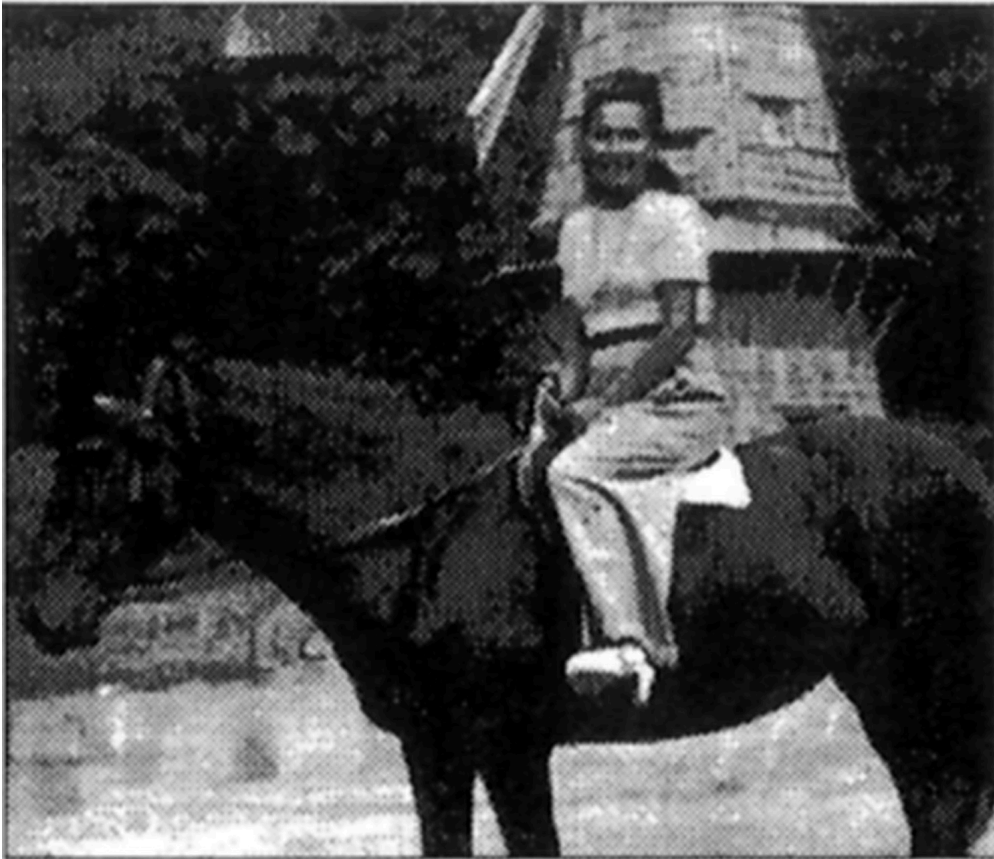
Dov as an infant in Brussels, held by his brother Shimon - from their mother's memoir, page 61, captioned "Shimon 'the big one' holding his baby brother, Dov". He was born 28 August 1946.



David (Memek) Rapaport (1911-12-25 - 1990-08-29)

David (Memek) with Lusia on their wedding day - from her memoir, page 15, captioned "Mazal tov! Lusia and Memek on their wedding day". One of only two photographs of him known to exist. The memoir dates the wedding February 1938 in Muszyna; the civil record says

10 February 1935 in Bolechow. Unresolved.



Leah Lusha Rapaport (nee Weitzner) (1913-04-08 - 1996-12-28)

Lusia on horseback in Bolechow, before the war - from her own memoir, where the caption reads "Lajka on the horse". Lajka was her nickname; the same page says she never knew what it meant. Her father called her wild, "like a naughty boy". This is the earliest photograph of her the archive holds.



Shimon Rapaport (1937-06-22 -)

Shimon at his school desk in Brussels, about 1946-47 - from his mother's memoir, where the caption reads "Shimon on the school bench in Brussels". He was nine or ten. Two and a half years of his childhood had been spent hidden in a crate.



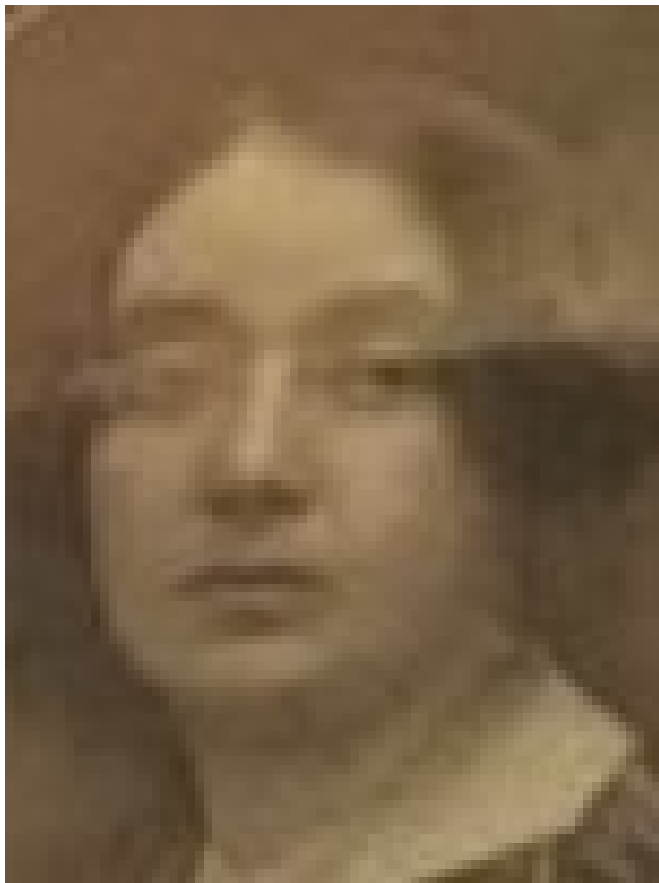
Berisz / Bernard / Dov Rapaport (1886-07-30 - 1942-03-29)

Berish Rapaport, 1924 - the photograph pasted onto his own qualification certificate that July, when David was twelve.



Alte Leja Rapaport (m. Turkel) (1882 - 1942)

Alte Lea Rapaport, later Turkel - David's aunt, one of Moses Saul's daughters. A studio portrait, undated; the dress and the hat put it near her 1909 marriage to Jechiel Turkel.



Freida Amalia Rapaport (1888 - 1942)

Freida Amalia Rapaport, later Nussbaum - David's aunt. The only likeness of her the family holds, and it survives as a thumbnail; it is published at the size it survives at rather than enlarged into something it is not.



Zwi (Hersh Heschel) Ayalon Nussbaum (1919-05-07 - 2001-11-27)

Zwi (Hirsch Herman) Nussbaum, c.1945 - from his citizenship application



Elias (Eliyahu) Weitzner

Elias Weitzner with his daughter Lusie in Israel - from her memoir, page 66, captioned "Lusia with her father, in Israel". He had emigrated in the 1930s; she stayed behind to finish her studies, and the war came.



Matel (Mathilde) Weitzner (nee Weinreb)

Matel Weinreb - from her daughter's memoir, page 67, captioned simply "Lusia's mother". The only photograph of her the archive holds.



Lea Rapaport (m. Segal / Fridman) (1912 -)

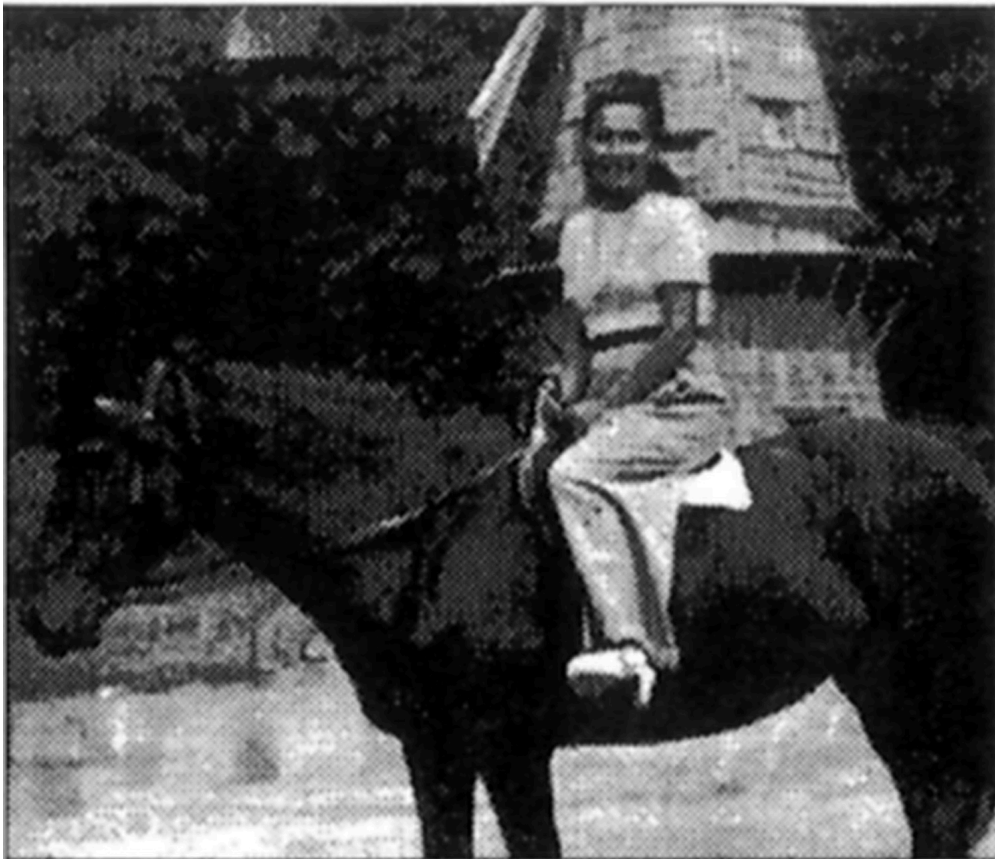
Lea Rapaport, later Segal and then Fridman - David's first cousin, daughter of his uncle Simon. Born 10 November 1912, eleven months after David.



Inge Nussbaum (nee Rosenbusch) (1922-07-03 - 2009-01-14)

Inge Nussbaum nee Rosenbusch, c.1945 - from her husband's citizenship application

The memoir plates - printed inside Lusia's own book



"Lajka" on the horse

The earliest photograph of Lusia the archive holds, and the only one from before the war. Two paragraphs above it the book explains the name: her father called her wild, "like a naughty boy", but Lajk



Mazal tov! Lusia and Memek on their wedding day

One of only two photographs of David known to exist. The memoir places the wedding in February 1938 on a day of ceaseless snow - it calls it a "white wedding" because the snow covered everything in pu



Shimon the baby

Shimon was born in 1937. The chapter this sits in is called "The first signs of antisemitism", and it opens with Luska wheeling him in his pram beside the river at Muszyna.



Shimon beside the family dog

The lines directly above this photograph record what became of the dog: one day it bit the Germans' cook, and was shot dead on the spot.



Shimon "the big one" holding his baby brother, Dov, in his arms

Brussels. The memoir puts Dov's birth in 1947; the records give 28 August 1946, and the records are right - so Shimon was nine here, not eight. Two and a half years of his own childhood had been spent



Shimon on the school bench in Brussels

Brussels, about 1946-47. He was nine or ten. Two and a half years of his childhood had been spent hidden in a crate, and here he is at a school desk.



Shimon's release certificate from the Atlit detention camp

A dated document and a photograph of him at once. Haifa, 22 August 1947, signed by the Director of the Immigration Office: "This is to certify that RAPAPORT SH... whose photograph is hereby attached, ha



The reunion, what a reunion: the brothers Shimon (left) and Dovik (right) with their cousin Akiva Eldar

The brothers meeting again. David and Shimon had gone ahead and been interned; Lusie and Dov followed on the ship Kedma, landing at Haifa. The caption names Akiva as their cousin. The archive records



Lusia with her father, in Israel

Elias Weitzner had emigrated in the 1930s while she stayed behind to finish her studies; they had not seen each other since. The page beside this photograph records her walking down a Haifa street, se



Lusia's mother

Matel Weinreb of Dolina, daughter of the innkeeper Samuel Weinreb. She married Elias Weitzner at Dolina in 1905. This is the only photograph of her the archive holds.



Lusia looks relaxed and happy in the State of Israel

The chapter is about the one-room flat on Abbas Street in Haifa - a small kitchen, the toilet outside, 250 steps to climb with the shopping, and no bus that came that way. She writes that she was happy



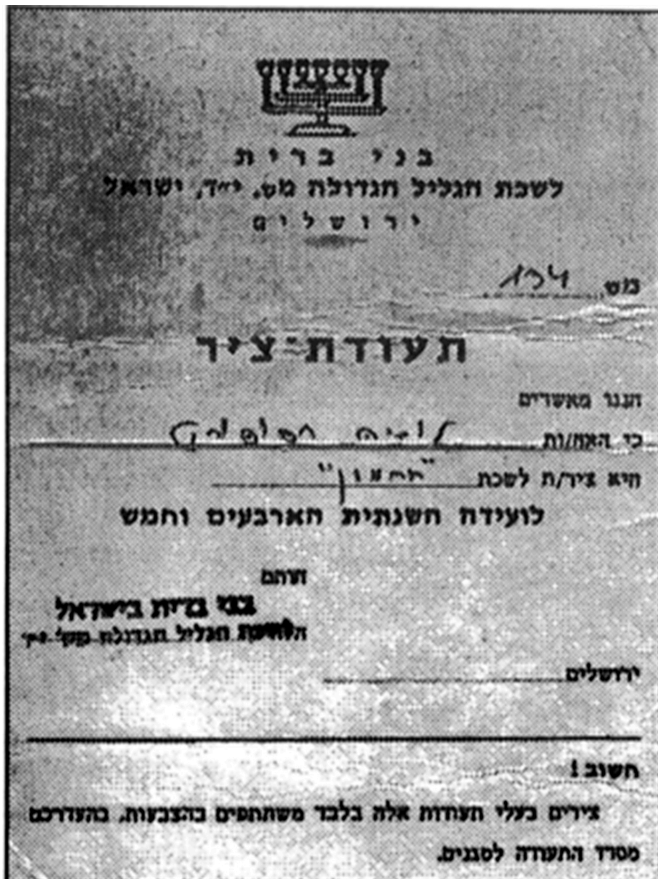
Lusia as a "Hawaiian girl" at the Purim party held at her home

The flat at Moriah Street 93 in Haifa, bought with the German reparations money. They cleared the furniture into the garden; she made the costume herself out of raffia; Memek handled the drinks and th



The Rapaport family on a picnic. Right to left: Memek, Shimon, Lusia and Dovik

The only photograph in this archive that holds all four of them at once - David, Lusia, Shimon and Dov, together and out of danger. Israel, undated; the surrounding chapter covers Lusia's eleven years



Lusia's delegate card for the B'nai B'rith convention

A "delegate certificate" issued by B'nai B'rith in Israel, Galilee Lodge, Jerusalem, naming her as delegate of the Hermon lodge to the forty-fifth annual convention. She ran the lodge's activity for c



Lusia Rapaport (pictured)

The back cover of the book. It carries no caption of its own - the blurb beside it names her, "Lusia Rapaport (pictured)". Undated; the memoir was dictated in 1986. It is the clearest photograph of he

The documents that matter most

Lusia's own Displaced Persons card, Brussels, 26 December 1945

Lusia's own card, the twin of David's. She registered in Brussels on 26 December 1945 - three and a half months BEFORE he did on 9 April 1946, and eight months before Dov was born there. She signed it Rapaport Lea while the clerk filed her under her maiden name and added "ep.se Rapaport" at the top. Three things it gives us. Her parents: father Elias, mother's maiden name MATHILDE WEINREB - the Weitzner-Weinreb line. The remark "Vient de Prague" - she came from a camp in Prague, which nothing else in this archive mentions and which is now an open question. And a birthplace that is simply wrong: HAIFA, PALESTINE. She was born in Bolechow. David's card of the same series gives Cieszyn, also wrong. Two cards, two wrong birthplaces - and on Lusia's the desired destination is Palestine. The archive records the pattern and asserts no motive.

ep.se RAPAPORT
(1) REGISTRATION No. **851018982**
WEITZNER *Lea.*

A.E.F. D.P. REGISTRATION RECORD
Original ☐ Duplicate ☐
M. ☒ Single ☐ Married ☐
F. ☐ Widowed ☐ Divorced ☐ *Polonaise*

(2) Family Name *Basia* Other Given Names *Talentine* (3) Sex *Female* (4) Marital Status *Single* (5) Claimed Nationality *Polonaise*
(6) Birthdate *8.4.1916* Birthplace *Haifa* Province *Talentine* Country *Israelik* (8) Number of Accompanying Family Members: *0*
(9) Number of Dependents: *0* (10) Full Name of Father *Elias* (11) Full Maiden Name of Mother *MATHILDE WEINREB*
(12) DESIRED DESTINATION *Talentine* (13) LAST PERMANENT RESIDENCE OR RESIDENCE JANUARY 1, 1938.
City or Village *Talentine* Province *Talentine* Country *Talentine* City or Village *Lemberg* Province *Pologne* Country *Pologne*
(14) Usual Trade, Occupation or Profession (15) Performed in What Kind of Establishment (16) Other Trades or Occupations
(17) Languages Spoken in Order of Fluency *a. allem. b. polon. c. Russ.* (18) Do You Claim to be a Prisoner of War ☐ Yes ☒ No
(20) Signature of Registrant: *Rapaport Lea* (21) Signature of Registrar: *[Signature]* Date: *26.12.45* Assembly Center No. *Bro.*
(22) Destination or Reception Center:
(23) Code for Issue
(24) REMARKS
Vient de Prague
se rend en Palestine

DP-2
10-30781-1

Document: Lusia's own Displaced Persons card, Brussels, 26 December 1945

Basia, received 19 August 2026. Same series and provenance as David's card: Commissariat Belge au Rapatriement, received by the BVM on 3 October 1969.

MEDICAL CLEARANCE CERTIFICATE										(31) SUPPLEMENTARY RECORD		
1st		2nd		1. 2.		1. 2.		1. 2.		1. 2.		Temporary identity certificate issued—:
				D. D. T.		AL. G. M. K. P.		HEAT.		OTHER		
(25) Dates of Disinfestation				Types								
(26) PHYSICAL CONDITION ON ARRIVAL				(27) IMMUNIZATION RECORD								
L.	M.	C. D.	D.	Type	Dose	Date	Initials					
				T (Epid)	1.							
					2.							
					3.							
				D.	1.							
					2.							
				T. T. (Tab.)	1.							
					2.							
					3.							
				O.								
				S.	Date	Initials	Reaction					
				Vacc.			I. V. VA.					
				Read.								
Arrival Medical Inspection —: <i>[Signature]</i>				(28) Final Medical Inspection —:								
Date <i>26.12.45</i>				Date								
Medical Examiner				Medical Examiner				M. R.				
(29) MOVEMENT AUTHORIZATION OR VISA				(30) RECEPTION CENTER RECORD								

Herkunft: Commissariat Belge au Rapatriement fiber
Ministère de la Santé Publique et de la Famille
erhalten: 3. 10. 1969 von der BVM

10-50751-1 U. S. GOVERNMENT PRINTING OFFICE

Document: Lusias own Displaced Persons card, Brussels, 26 December 1945

Basia, received 19 August 2026. Same series and provenance as David's card: Commissariat Belge au Rapatriement, received by the BVM on 3 October 1969.

Request for temporary residence in Belgium, 28 December 1945

Two days after she registered as a displaced person, a Jewish aid society asked the Belgian authorities to let her stay six months. It repeats the two strange things from her card - born Haifa, came from a camp in Prague - and adds an address: 250 rue des Coteaux, Schaerbeek. That is where Lusias was living in Brussels, and where she was still living when Dov was born eight months later.

[unreadable: lusia_residence_request_1945-12-28.pdf - FzErrorFormat]

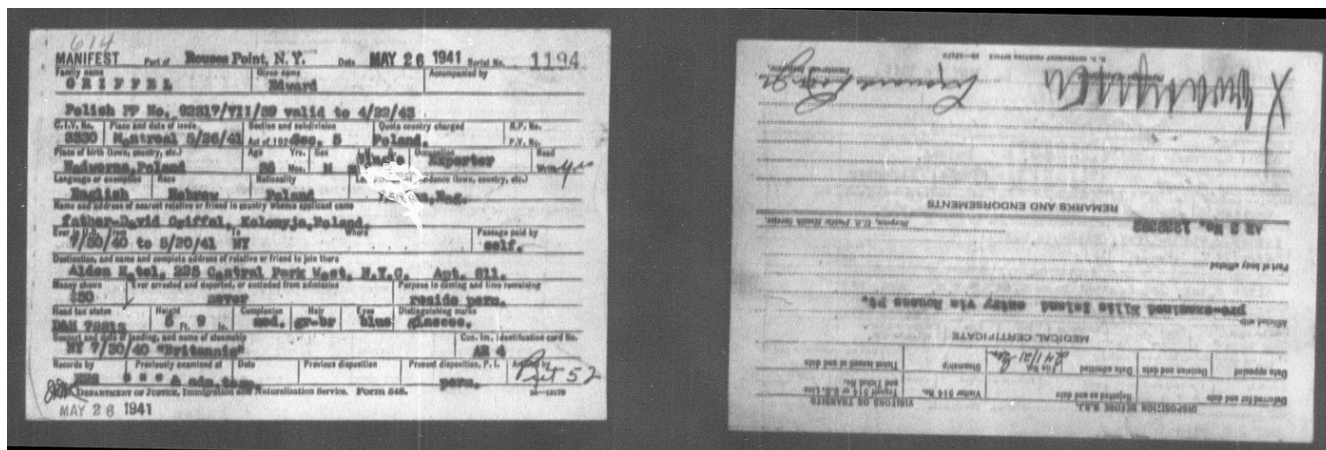
Belgian Ministry of Justice - permission to stay pending emigration, 7 February 1946

The state answering. Six weeks after the aid society asked, the Ministry of Justice told the Schaerbeek police to enter her in the aliens' register and issue a Modele C certificate marked EN VUE D'ÉMIGRATION - permission to be in Belgium only while waiting to leave it. Three months at a time, twice renewable. Dov was born under this arrangement.

[unreadable: lusia_stay_permit_1946-02-07.pdf - FzErrorFormat]

US immigration manifest - Edward Griffel enters at Rouses Point, N.Y., 26 May 1941

A Griffel who got out. Edward, born in Nadworna, thirty-eight years old, an exporter, crossed into the United States from Montreal on 26 May 1941 to reside permanently, giving his father David Griffel at Kolomyja as his nearest relative in the country he came from. Doron reports that Basia has now finished the Weitzner side and found many of them emigrated to the United States, settling mainly in New Jersey; this card is the same movement on the Griffel side, and it is dated eight months before the family in Galicia was destroyed.

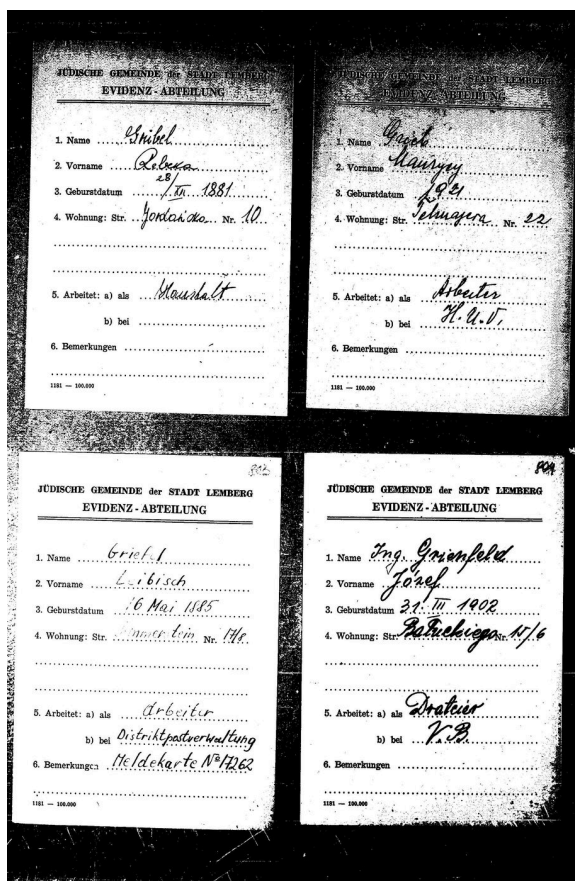


Document: US immigration manifest - Edward Griffel enters at Rouses Point, N.Y., 26 May 1941

Jacob, Griffel family archive, received 10 August 2026

Jewish Community of the City of Lemberg, registration department - four cards, one of them Leibisch Griffel

Registration cards of the Jewish Community of Lemberg - Lwow - from the years the ghetto was administered. One of the four is Leibisch Griffel, Rebeka's brother and David's uncle by marriage: born 16 May 1885, living at Sommerstein 17/8, working for the District Post Administration, registration card number 17262. It places him in Lwow, in work, inside the system that was counting Jews. His Yad Vashem record gives his death only as "Shoah", with no year. This card is the last document that shows him alive.



Document: Jewish Community of the City of Lemberg, registration department - four cards, one of them

Jacob, Griffel family archive, received 10 August 2026

Displaced Persons (DIPIS) card - David Rapaport, Brussels 1946

[unreadable: Karta David Rapaport 1 strona.pdf - FzErrorFormat]

[unreadable: Karta David Rapaport 2 strona.pdf - FzErrorFormat]

Birth record - Dawid Mendel Rapaport, Nadworna 1911

The image shows a photograph of an open birth record book. The left page is titled "Stronica 207" and contains a table with columns for birth date, place, and names. The right page is titled "UWAGA" and contains a table with columns for birth date, place, and names. The records are handwritten in ink.

Document: Birth record - Dawid Mendel Rapaport, Nadworna 1911

Jewish Historical Institute (Żydowski Instytut Historyczny / ŻIH), Warsaw - Bolechow district records / Galician Jewish vital records

Swiadectwo kwalifikacyjne' (Qualification Certificate), Stanislawow, 29 July 1924 - identification REOPENED 6 August 2026

This record was closed on 25 May 2026 as belonging to a different man, and its people were removed. That verdict rested on the second file in it - a Tarnow birth register page recording a Benzion Rapaport born 6 August 1884 to Mojzesz Rapaport and Regina Schiff. That page is indeed someone else. But it is not this certificate. The certificate, read in full from Basia's own scan on 6 August 2026, says: applicant Rapaport Berisch; father Mojzesz Saul; origin Tarnow, Folwarczna 9; present address Stanislawow, Kosciuszki 4; and, under children aged fourteen and under, Mendel 12 lat, Lotte 8 lat". David Mendel was twelve in July 1924 and Lota was eight. Basia has now filed this certificate inside our Berish's own folder. Four things point one way - the father's name, the Stanislawow address the archive already held for him, the two children by name and age, and a date one month before his August 1924 passport application. The 1884 Tarnow birth entry points the other way and stays on the record. The question is open again rather than settled the other way, and it is one for Basia.

Świadectwo kwalifikacyjne
ważne w ciągu dni 14.

Nr. 93.

Nazwisko i imię ojca: Rapaport Mojżesz Saul

Rysopis:
Wzrost: średni
Twarz: ociągła
Włosy: ciemne
Oczy: przepięte, ciemne
Znaki szczególne:

Nr. dokumentu osobistego wydanego przez Starostę 2.12.1924/2
Miejsce faktycznego zamieszkania ostatnio w ciągu 6 miesięcy Stanisławów Kowieński 4
Obecny dokładny adres Berisch Rapaport Stanisławów Kowieński
Miejsce zapisania do ksiąg ludności stałej organizacji stanowej ewent. przynależność gmina Żagbrowa

nazwisko i imię petenta: Rapaport Berisch
imię ojca: Mojżesz Saul
adres: Amara 3

Dzieci do lat 14 włącznie:
Mendel 12 lat
Lejla 8 lat

Dzieci: (imię, wiek i płeć):

(imię, wiek i płeć):

data:

podpis (osobiste sprawozdanie):

podpis petenta:

Ze strony policji przeszkód do wydania nie ma
do wydania nie ma przeszkód
dokumentu podróży niema

Uwagi:

dn. 29/7 1924 r. Urząd

podpis:

Do nabycia w drukarni Leona Dankowskiego, Stanisławów, Lipowa 5.

Document: Świadectwo kwalifikacyjne' (Qualification Certificate), Stanisławów, 29 July 1924 - ident
Polish Galician archives - located 23 May 2026 by Basia. WA0001 = application form. WA0002 = passport photograph.

Prośba o pozwolenie na wyjazd zagranicę.

Ja niżej podpisany Berisch Rapaport
(osoba) przebywający zamieszkały w Stanisławowie
w 1918 urodzonym, iż jestem obywatel cz.
Rodzimego Łebki, urodzonym 2 1886 na dzień 30 lipca
posiadam dokument osłony: Stanisławów 16 listopada 1924/2
i sprzącam o wydanie mi paszportu zagranicznego na wyjazd.
Dziś do lat 14, a nie osiągnęły wieku i pełnoletności:
Imię: _____ Wiek: _____ Płeć: _____ Punkt wyjazdu nie dotyczy

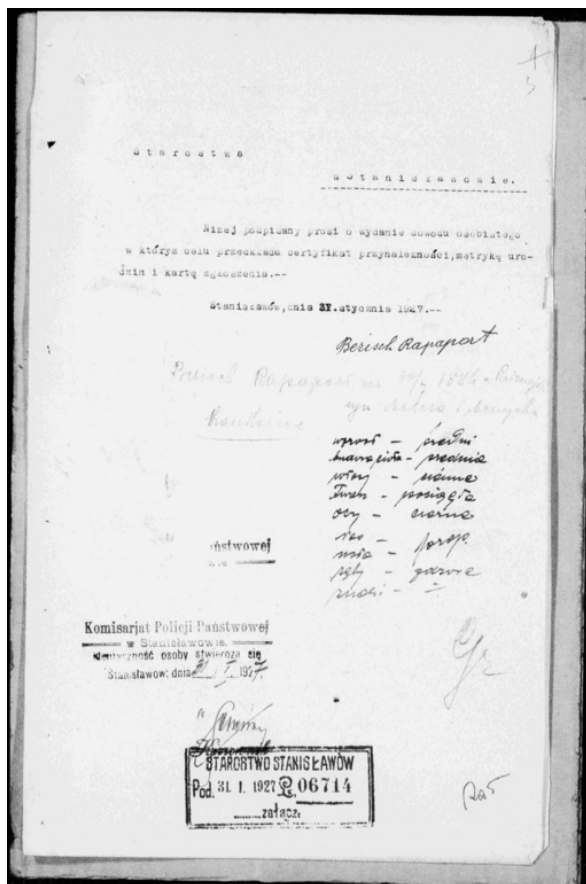
1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

Zobowiązanie świadectwa kwalifikacyjnego, fotografie oraz dokumenty:
1. Świadectwo urodzin Amara 3
2. Książka przemieszczalności Amara 3
3. Świadectwo losowania Amara 3
4. Książka wyjazdowa

Adres: Berisch Rapaport, Kowieński 4
Data: Amara 1924

STANISŁAWÓW
dn. 14 VII 1924 r. 13534

Document: Świadectwo kwalifikacyjne' (Qualification Certificate), Stanisławów, 29 July 1924 - ident
Polish Galician archives - located 23 May 2026 by Basia. WA0001 = application form. WA0002 = passport photograph.



Document: Świadectwo kwalifikacyjne' (Qualification Certificate), Stanisławow, 29 July 1924 - ident

Polish Galician archives - located 23 May 2026 by Basia. WA0001 = application form. WA0002 = passport photograph.

Yad Vashem Page of Testimony - Bernard Dov Rapaport (filed 1953)

Primary documentary confirmation of Berish's parents (Moshe + Menukha) and Holocaust fate (Auschwitz). PoT year of birth (1888) differs from passport application (1886) - the passport is a contemporary primary document and is the more reliable source for date. WHO FILED IT. The declaration at the foot gives a filer living in Haifa, at a street only partly legible with house number 93, signing on 26 April 1953. Where the form asks what the filer was to the person, the word written is - his son. The signature reads . The identification does not rest on that signature: Berish and Rebeka had one son, David, their other child being Lota, so "his son" is David whoever wrote the letters. He filed it seven years after reaching the country, for parents he had last seen before the war. Yad Vashem's own database would show the submitter independently; it refused connection from this machine on 11 August 2026, so that confirmation is still outstanding.

[unreadable: Bernard Dov Rapaport.pdf - FzErrorFormat]

Yad Vashem Page of Testimony - Regina Rivka Rapaport (filed 1953)

Primary documentary confirmation that Rebecca (Regina Rivka nee Griffel) lived in Przemyśl before and during the war, and perished in the Shoah. Year of birth (1892) differs from the Griffel pedigree (1888) - likely an error by the 1953 submitter. WHO FILED IT. The declaration at the foot gives a filer living in Haifa, at a street only partly legible with house number 93, signing on 26 April 1953. Where the form asks what the filer was to the person, the word written is - her son. The signature reads . The identification does not rest on that signature: Berish and Rebeka had one son, David, their other child being Lota, so "her son" is David whoever wrote the letters. He filed it seven years after reaching the country, for parents he had last seen before the war. Yad Vashem's own database would show the submitter independently; it refused connection from this machine on 11 August 2026, so that confirmation is still outstanding.

[unreadable: Regina Rivka Rapaport.pdf - FzErrorFormat]

Auschwitz Museum victim record - Bernard Rapaport #188161

The museum page itself, received from Basia on 6 August 2026. It closes a gap this record had left open in its own words. Birth date and birthplace match our Berish exactly - 30 July 1886, Radomysł Wielki. He was given prisoner number 27310, arrived at the camp on 27 March 1942 and died there on 29 March 1942. Two days. His occupation is entered as robotnik, labourer; he was an industrialist in Stanisławow, and the word is the camp's, not his. The

family's 1953 Yad Vashem testimony says 1940 - written eleven years later and two years out. Both are kept; the register is nearer.

Rapaport Berisch



Miejsce i data urodzenia
Data urodzenia : **30-07-1886**
Miejsce urodzenia : Radomysl Wielki

Zawód
robotnik

Los
Nadany numer 27310
przybycie do obozu Auschwitz 27-03-1942
zginął 29.3.1942 r. w KL Auschwitz

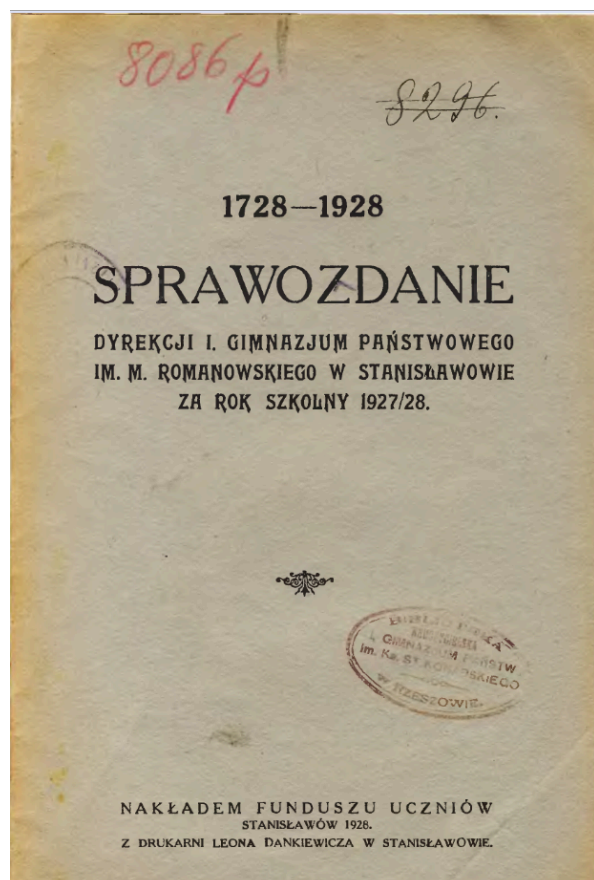
Powrót

Document: Auschwitz Museum victim record - Bernard Rapaport #188161

Auschwitz-Birkenau State Museum, Database of victims

David at school - annual reports of the First State Gymnasium, Stanislawow, 1926 and 1927/28

Sprawozdanie Dyrekcji I. Gimnazjum Państwowego im. M. Romanowskiego w Stanisławowie za rok szkolny 1927/28 - the annual report of the First State Gymnasium named for Mieczysław Romanowski, printed in Stanisławow in 1928 by Leon Dankiewicz, the same printer whose name sits at the foot of Berish's 1924 certificate. It marks the school's bicentenary, 1728-1928. This is where David was a pupil: the family had been in Stanisławow since 1918 and lived at Kosciuszki 4. One of the three files Basia sent is labelled nieukonczone - unfinished - and the archive repeats that label rather than guessing what it refers to.



Document: David at school - annual reports of the First State Gymnasium, Stanislawow, 1926 and 1927/

Basia, Ahnenblatt family archive, received 6 August 2026

Baumgarten Józef (12/IX 1928) d)
 Freid Izidor (21/I 1928) Horn Maks
 Pines Gustaw (11/IX 1927) Łucki Aleksander
 Pulikowski Grzegorz (30/I 1928) Semann Mojżesz
 Walis Emil (1/IX 1927) Szafran Zygmund Bolesław

KLASA Vb (27)

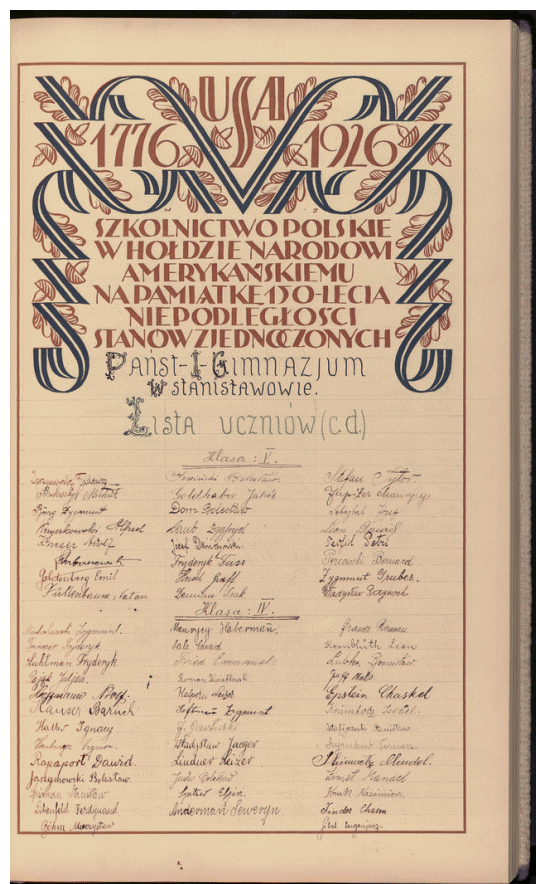
a) Sebastian Mieczysław
 Artmann Hersch Simon Gabriel
 Axtmayer Leopold Spinnrad Dawid
 Bittmann Izrael Spunberg Izidor
 Böhm Mieczysław Turteltaub Emanuel
 Braude Salomon Wieselberg Zygmunt
 Geller Mojżesz Zimmermann Nuchem
 Hoffmann Adolf b)
 Lindner Izak Brandstein Usher (3/II 1928)
 Lindner Leizer
 Lityński Witold
 Margules Samuel d)
 Ostaficzuk Stanisław
 Rathauser Marcell Haller Ignacy
 Rubel Mojżesz Faltiel Gerszon
 Schindler Beno Rapaport Dawid
 Schrager Józef

KLASA VI (38)

Anderman Seweryn Pająk Julian
 Epstein Chaskiel Raymoch Władysław
 Feld Jerzy Salz Edward
 Finder f. Rapaport Chaim Sawiak Stefan
 Gawłowski Józef Sowiński Bolesław
 Gibel Eugenjusz Spirman Stanisław
 Gottlieb Chaim Spitzer Eljasz
 Graff f. Sofer Maks Szymków Tomasz
 Grauer Roman Trinczer Fryderyk
 Habermann Maurycy Zimet Mandel
 Halpern Leizer b)
 Hauser Boruch
 Kornbluth Leon Fediów Eustachy (30/III 1928)
 Krumholz Izrael Snihurowicz Wł. (16/XI 1927)
 Krzyżkowski Alfred
 Kwiatkowski Roman c)
 Lichtenfeld Ferdynand
 Michalski Stanisław Juśko Bolesław
 Michalewski Zygmunt

Document: David at school - annual reports of the First State Gymnasium, Stanisławow, 1926 and 1927/

Basia, Ahnenblatt family archive, received 6 August 2026



Document: David at school - annual reports of the First State Gymnasium, Stanisławow, 1926 and 1927/

Basia, Ahnenblatt family archive, received 6 August 2026

Auschwitz Sterbebucher (death books) 1941-1943 - Berisch Rapaport, died 29 March 1942

The camp's own death books, kept for prisoners registered in Auschwitz between July 1941 and December 1943 - 46 partially preserved volumes, 65,280 names. Berisch Rapaport, born 30 July 1886 at Radomysl Wielki, died 29 March 1942. This is a second and independent witness to the date the Museum victim page gives, and the two agree to the day. It also carries something the Museum page does not: residence PRZEMYSL. Lusia's memoir says David's parents were in Przemyśl when the war came, and that the Germans killed one of them there on a fabricated accusation. The register, written by the men who ran the camp, puts him in the same town. A memoir written from memory decades later and a German clerk's entry made at the time agree, and neither could have been copying the other.

Berisch Rapaport

Name [Images](#) [Source](#) [Links](#)

Name

Name Record ID	12520683
Primary Name	Berisch Rapaport
Date of Birth	Jul 30, 1886
Date of Death	Mar 29, 1942
Place of Birth	Radomysl Wielki
Residence	Przemyśl
Religion	Jew

Document: Auschwitz Sterbebucher (death books) 1941-1943 - Berisch Rapaport, died 29 March 1942

Auschwitz Death Certificates 1941-1943 (Sterbebucher), source record 49478; name record 12520683. Received from Basia 6 August 2026.

The above name appears in the following source record.

Source Record ID 49478

Source Title [🔗 Auschwitz Death Certificates 1941-1943](#)

Description Contains partially preserved Death Books (Sterbebücher) of Auschwitz Concentration Camp prisoners. The source appears to be the Sterbebücher, 46 volumes of deaths of prisoners who were registered in the camp and died between July 29, 1941 and December 31, 1943. Information provided is last name, first name(s), date of birth, date of death, birthplace, residence, and religion.

Event Date Between Jul 29, 1941 – Dec 31, 1943

Number of Persons (Exact) 65,280

Place of Death Auschwitz [Concentration camp], Poland

Document: Auschwitz Sterbebücher (death books) 1941-1943 - Berisch Rapaport, died 29 March 1942

Auschwitz Death Certificates 1941-1943 (Sterbebücher), source record 49478; name record 12520683. Received from Basia 6 August 2026.

Yad Vashem Page of Testimony 53075 - Lotte Schmid-Rapaport, filed by her brother David, 26 April 1953

The third form David filled in that day. His sister Lotte was born in Vienna in 1914 - this page says 1914, the family trees say 27 September 1915, and both are kept - daughter of Berish and Rebeka, married, a Polish national in 1939, and she died at Lwow. This archive held no death for her at all: she was a birth record from Vienna and then nothing. Her brother, writing in Haifa eight years after the war, put down where she died and signed himself , her brother. He did not fill in the year. The married name on the page, Schmid, is new here too - nothing else in this archive records that she married, or whom. CROSS-CHECKED 11 August 2026 against both family archives. Basia holds her as Charlotta Rapaport, born 27 September 1915 in Vienna, married to "... Szmid" - the surname without a given name - and records NO death. Jacob holds her as Lota Rapaport, born about 1915, with no marriage and no death. So the married name is confirmed twice over and the place of death is confirmed nowhere else: this page is the only statement about her fate in any of the three archives. Note also that

יד ושם

[illegible]

Yad Vashem, Page of Testimony No. 53075. Copy from Basia, Ahnenblatt family archive, received 6 August 2026; read 11 August 2026.

Dov went back - his four journeys, 2015 to 2019

Warsaw - 14-20 April 2015 (36 photographs, 6 shown here)

The Old Town, the Barbican, the Royal Castle, the rebuilt squares - and the churches and streets of a city that was flattened and put back stone by stone.



Warsaw, 14-20 April 2015

Dov Rapaport with his son Doron



Warsaw, 14-20 April 2015

Dov Rapaport with his son Doron



Warsaw, 14-20 April 2015

Dov Rapaport with his son Doron



Warsaw, 14-20 April 2015

Dov Rapaport with his son Doron



Warsaw, 14-20 April 2015

Dov Rapaport with his son Doron



Warsaw, 14-20 April 2015

Dov Rapaport with his son Doron

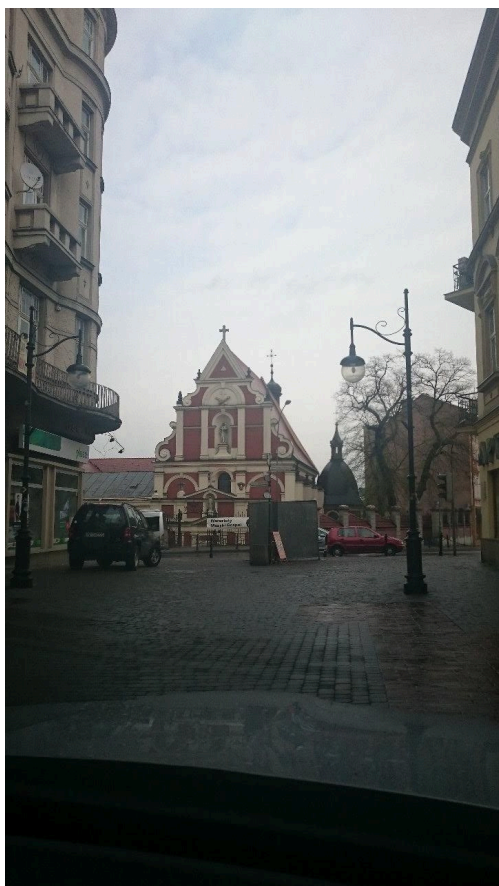
Przemysl - 19 April 2015 (40 photographs, 6 shown here)

The town where Berish and Rebeka were living when the war came. The camp death books give Przemysl as Berish's residence, and Lusía's memoir says the Germans killed one of David's parents here. Most of these frames are taken through a car windscreen, driving its streets slowly, in the rain.



Przemysl, 19 April 2015

Dov Rapaport with his son Doron



Przemysl, 19 April 2015

Dov Rapaport with his son Doron



Przemyśl, 19 April 2015

Dov Rapaport with his son Doron



Przemyśl, 19 April 2015

Dov Rapaport with his son Doron



Przemysl, 19 April 2015

Dov Rapaport with his son Doron



Przemysl, 19 April 2015

Dov Rapaport with his son Doron

Brussels - 21-23 June 2018 (13 photographs, 6 shown here)

Where Dov was born on 28 August 1946, four months after his father registered as a displaced person in this city and wrote "Palestine or U.S.A." in the box for where he wanted to go.



Brussels, 21-23 June 2018

Dov Rapaport with his son Doron



Brussels, 21-23 June 2018

Dov Rapaport with his son Doron



Brussels, 21-23 June 2018

Dov Rapaport with his son Doron



Brussels, 21-23 June 2018

Dov Rapaport with his son Doron



Brussels, 21-23 June 2018

Dov Rapaport with his son Doron



Brussels, 21-23 June 2018

Dov Rapaport with his son Doron

Katowice - 17-19 January 2019 (31 photographs, 6 shown here)

The town of chapter 5 - where the family was together before the separation nobody recorded. Photographed in winter, from above and on foot.



Katowice, 17-19 January 2019

Dov Rapaport with his son Doron



Katowice, 17-19 January 2019

Dov Rapaport with his son Doron



Katowice, 17-19 January 2019

Dov Rapaport with his son Doron



Katowice, 17-19 January 2019

Dov Rapaport with his son Doron



Katowice, 17-19 January 2019

Dov Rapaport with his son Doron



Katowice, 17-19 January 2019

Dov Rapaport with his son Doron

WHAT THE SOURCES DISAGREE ABOUT

- Berish's death: the Auschwitz Museum and the camp Sterbebucher both say 29 March 1942; the Yad Vashem page David filed in 1953 says 1940. Both are published.
- Rebeka: this archive holds born 1888 died 1942; her Yad Vashem page says 1892 and 1943; Jacob's tree says 1942 with a question mark. All three stand.
- Lotte: born 27 September 1915 per the trees, 1914 per her Yad Vashem page. Her cousin Charlotte Horowitz was born 21 November 1914 in the same city. Do not merge them.
- David's birthplace: Nadworna per the birth certificate; Cieszyn on his 1946 DP card. Lusia's card says she was born in HAIFA, PALESTINE - she was born in Bolechow. Two cards, two wrong birthplaces, and on hers the destination is Palestine.

OPEN QUESTIONS - these are questions, not findings

A film that answers them invents history. A film that ends on them tells the truth about what this family still does not know.

- Did Szabse Rapaport die in 1884 or in 1897 - and is he the same man as Shabtai Rappaport, head of the rabbinical court of Dabrowa?
- Why did David go to Palestine first, with nine-year-old Shimon, and leave Lusia and the baby Dov behind in Brussels - even at the cost of a year behind wire in Cyprus?
- Where is 'Mosina' - the town where David and Leah married, where Shimon was born, where they lived until 1939?
- What is Leah's actual date of birth - 8 April 1913, 6 April 1916, 8 April 1916, or ~1917?
- Verify David's signature on the 1946 Brussels DP card against any later document
- How did David survive 1939-1946? Did he serve in the Polish Army? Was he deported to Siberia? Did he escape via Anders' Army to Iran in 1942?
- How did Leah and 4-year-old Shimon survive in Poland 1941-1944? Were they in the ghetto or on the Aryan side?
- When Leah was in Przemyśl (1939), whose home did she stay at - her mother Matel's (but Matel was in Palestine since 1933) or her mother-in-law Rebeka/Regina's?
- Extend research to the Griffel and Chajes families of Nadworna - Dana, Doron and Daniel's paternal gg-grandparents (via Rebeka Griffel David)
- Does Betar Poland have archives that would record David's membership?
- Why does Lusia appear in Polish records 1945-46 but not Dawid, while Dawid appears in Brussels DP records but not Lusia? When and where did they reunite for Dov's 1946 Brussels birth?
- What's in the Lusia ZIH registration cards Basia is requesting from Warsaw?
- Apply to IPN (Institute of National Remembrance) for any David / Leah / Shimon Rapaport records - KL camps, Gestapo, Stutthof
- Which ship brought the Rapaport family from Brussels DP to Cyprus and on to Israel? Strongest candidate: Theodor Herzl (April 1947).
- Even though Nadworna is confirmed, check Cieszyn archives in Katowice to be exhaustive
- Who were Moses Saul Rapaport's parents - were they Shabtai (Szabse) + Ita Feigi?
- Did Jente Rapaport survive the war, and what became of her line?
- Is Markus Turkel (m. Szewa Horowitz, Liege 1946) the same as Mordechai 'Max' Levi-Turkel (m. Margalit Halperin, Palestine 1947)?
- Which camp in Prague did Lusia come from, and when was she there? Her DP card and the 1945 residence request both say she came from a camp in Prague. Nothing else in this archive - and nothing in her own memoir - mentions Prague at all.
- Why do both Rapaport DP cards give a wrong birthplace - Haifa for Lusia, Cieszyn for David - and does the fact that Lusia's stated destination was Palestine bear on it? No source states a reason.